

Conservation Areas | Quinte Conservation

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Public Notice: Herbicide Application Taking Place for Water Soldier Management control efforts for invasive Water Soldier will be taking place in the Bay of Quinte starting the week of October 5th. Residents in areas of application have been notified. Visit: <https://www.invadingspecies.com/programs/water-soldier-eradication/> to follow along with management efforts. Conservation Authority Amalgamation Update In accordance with changes to the Conservation Authorities Act, Ontario's 36 conservation authorities will amalgamate into 9 Regional Conservation Authorities effective February 1, 2027. As part of this transition, Quinte Conservation (QC), Kawartha Conservation (KC), Ganaraska Conservation Authority (GCA), Otonabee Conservation Authority (OCA), Crowe Valley Conservation (CVC), Lower Trent Conservation (LTC), and Cataraqui Conservation (CC) are preparing to merge into the Eastern Lake Ontario Regional Conservation Authority (ELORCA). Throughout this process and beyond February 1, 2027, Quinte Conservation will continue to provide and carry out all of its programs with the high level of service expected by our residents, municipal partners, and stakeholders. Our commitment to delivering exceptional programs and services across the watershed remains unchanged. If you have questions about Quinte Conservation's programs and services, or the transition to ELORCA, please contact us at info@quinteconservation.ca. Our management team will be pleased to assist you. Conservation lands were created to protect local ecosystems and keep our watersheds healthy. We own and manage a variety of conservation areas throughout Quinte watershed. These areas are open to the public. Quinte Conservation areas offer outdoor activities that help people connect with nature and support healthy living. Across Ontario, conservation authorities privately own these lands. What you can do and what's available at each site may vary by region. Conservation lands were established with the purpose of protecting the natural ecology and the overall health of our watersheds. Lands that had potential for recreational activities like hiking, birdwatching, and, picnicking are known as conservation areas. Conservation authorities throughout Ontario privately own these lands and activities, amenities, and use vary depending on the region. Quinte Conservation owns just over 30,000 acres of land throughout the 6,000 km² watershed. Some of those properties are conservation areas that are open for public use and collectively make up 75 km of nature trails. Quinte Conservation has partnered with Paddle Pod Canada to introduce self-serve kayak rentals at Depot Lakes and Massasauga Point Conservation Areas. The two-year pilot project brings affordable, on-demand access to kayaking through a simple mobile app that lets visitors unlock a kayak, paddle, and life jacket, along with receiving real-time weather and water safety notifications. The Paddle Pods will be available from late June through late September in both 2026 and 2027, with rentals starting at \$17.99 for the first hour. This new amenity complements recent improvements at Depot Lakes and supports Quinte Conservation's commitment to

promoting wellbeing by encouraging more people to enjoy time outdoors and experience local conservation areas from the water. If successful, the program may become a permanent feature at select locations. *Prices updated July 14, 2026 as per direction from Paddle Pod Canada. These natural spaces are not parks and shouldn't be considered as such. Non-permitted activities can have a serious impact on plants and wildlife and can be detrimental to rare and endangered species. Non-permitted activities are chargeable offences under Section 29 of the Conservation Authorities Act. Those in violation of the Act may be subject to a fine. Motorized vehicles are not permitted outside of designated parking areas. The cross-country skiing trails at North Potter's Creek and Vanderwater Conservation Areas are groomed after significant snowfall for passive cross-country skiing uses. Trails are multi-use and skiers may cross paths with other pedestrians.